Lime gives a distinctive, vibrant twist to this clean-tasting, healthy soup from New Mexico. It has the added advantage of being very quick and easy to prepare.

green lentil soup with lime

SERVES 4 **PREP** 5 MINS **COOKING** 30 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
AT THE END OF STEP 3

1 quart (1 liter) chicken stock
2–3 sprigs fresh thyme
10oz (300g) green lentils
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
grated zest and juice of 1 organic lime

1 Pour the stock into a saucepan over medium heat. Add the thyme and bring to a simmer.

2 Add the lentils, and season lightly with salt and pepper. Return to a simmer, cover, reduce the heat a little. Cook for 20–25 minutes until the lentils are very soft.

3 Turn off the heat and let cool for several minutes. Transfer to a blender or food processor, and process until just smooth.

4 Pour the soup back into the saucepan and stir in the lime zest and juice. Reheat gently, taste, and adjust the seasoning. Serve very hot.